

Prompt. Make. Repeat.

AI tools as creative partners for building proof of concepts.





Hi, I'm Jarl.

Designer and developer in Copenhagen. Fifteen years on large, complicated digital projects.

And a ton of stupid, crazy, hopefully funny and quirky ones.

The two feed each other. That is what today is about.

Let me show you something.



LITTLE ROCKET · A MEDITATIVE BROWSER SPACE GAME

01 / 08



EMOTIONWAVE · A LIVING WEBSITE THAT REACTS TO THE WORLD'S MOOD

02 / 08

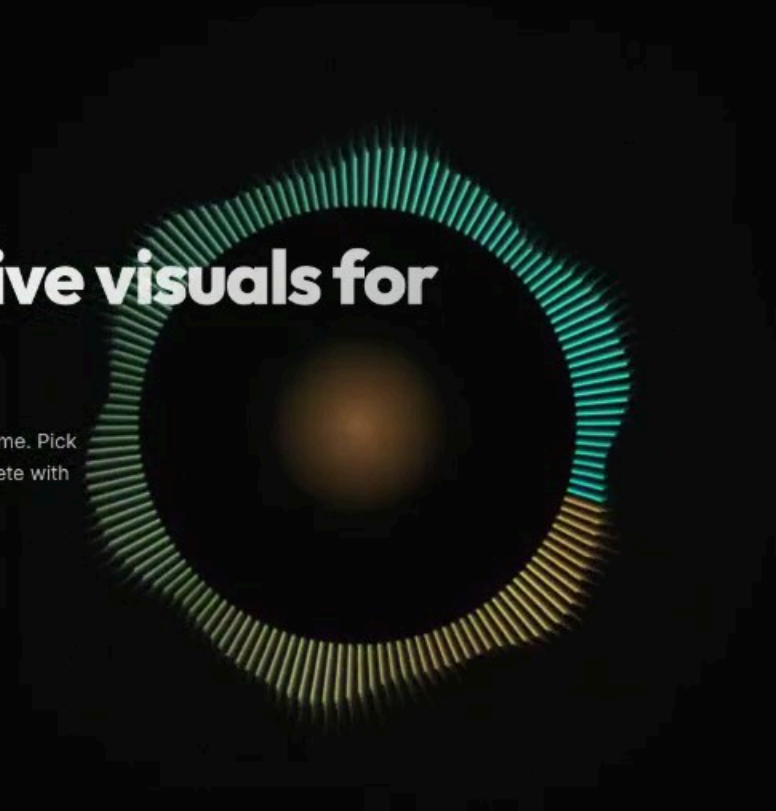
SOUND INTO LIGHT

Live audio-reactive visuals for macOS

Metal-powered 2D visuals that react to your sound in real time. Pick your input, choose a theme, hit Ready, and perform. Complete with DAW plugin, OSC and MIDI control.

[How to route DAW audio, interfaces, or microphones →](#)

[Get Echolume](#)



How many beers would it take you to enjoy this song?



It's Gonna Be Me

NSYNC



How many beers does this song need? 🍺

> [Skip Song](#)





MITSpil prototype - alle tal er testdata

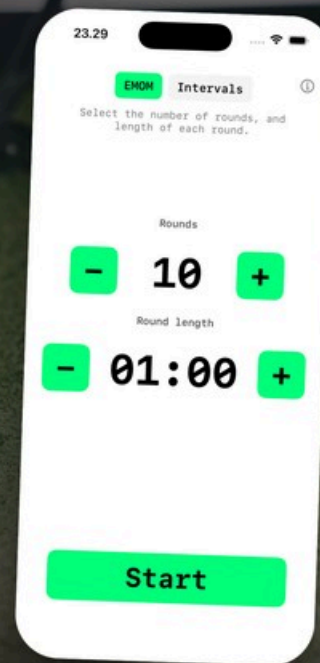
EMOM & INTERVAL TIMER

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CALM. PRIVATE. NO SHAME.

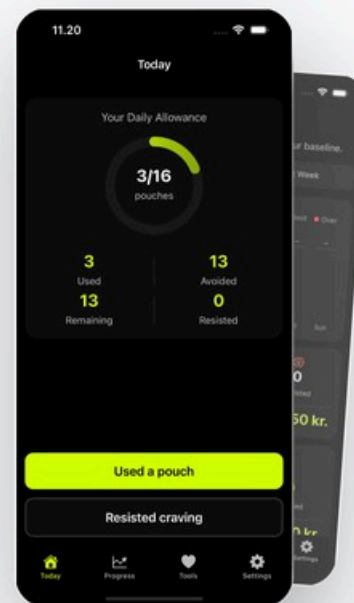
A gentler way to quit nicotine.

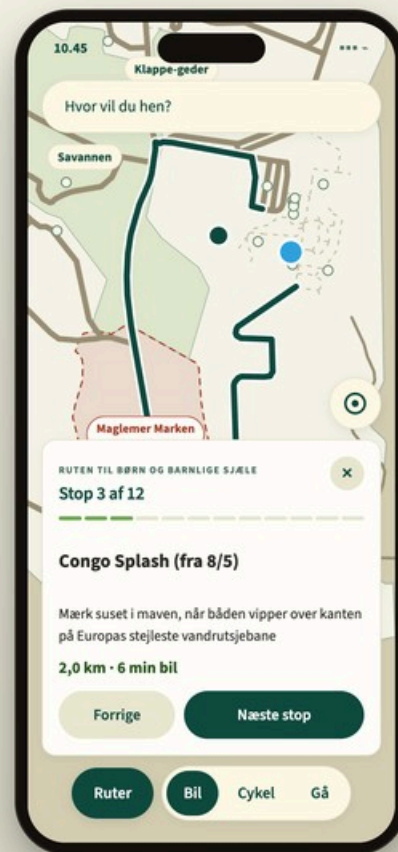
Wean Nicotine helps you reduce snus and nicotine pouches gradually, at your own pace, on your own device.



[See the app](#)

No accounts · No usage tracking · No subscriptions · Your data stays on your device





Knuthenborg wayfinding

Den rigtige app kører på iPhone og Android. Det her er en demo med præcis samme logik — rutevalg, parkregler, fodringstider og åbningstider er den samme kode.

HVOR STÅR GÆSTEN?

Klik et sted på kortet. Står du i parken, så tryk på positionsknappen nederst til højre — så følger appen din rigtige GPS.

HVAD ER KLOKKEN?

Fodringer ligger på hverdage i dagtimerne, og parken lukker kl. 17.



HVORDAN ER VEJRET?

Vejret hentes rigtigt fra Open-Meteo. Her kan du overstyre det, så du kan se hvad appen siger i regnvejir uden at vente på det.



Vejdata © OpenStreetMap-bidragydere, ODbL. Indhold, fodringstider og åbningstider fra Knuthenborg. Fire fodringssteder har en skannet placering — det står i panelet, når det er tilfældet.

You're going to do this too. Twice.

Starting in twelve minutes.

The deal

01

No tool tour

Tools show up when they are needed, not before.

02

No perfect prompts

This is not a prompting course.

03

You build

From minute twelve, and for the rest of the session.

How these tools actually behave

Not a technical walkthrough. One mental model that covers all of them.

They fill every gap you leave

MECHANISM

None of them look anything up. They produce what usually comes next: in words, in layouts, in code.

So they are exceptional at FORM: structure, tone, layout, genre.

CONSEQUENCE

Every gap in your instruction gets filled with an average.

That is why “an app for scheduling” gives you something that could be about anything, in a design you did not choose.

It has no memory. It re-reads everything, every time.

THE MECHANISM

There is no “it remembers”. Every time you press send, it reads the whole conversation again, from the top, and answers.

That is the context window.

WHAT YOU'LL FEEL

Long threads get worse, not better. Start a new one when you change subject.

Put what matters first. The middle gets read worst.

Everything you want it to know,
you have to give it.

Are you ready?

You were promised twelve minutes. It has been eleven. I think.

So, what are you going to make?

01

A missing tool

Something you keep doing by hand that a small app could just do for you.

02

The unfundable one

The idea that dies on slide four every time.
Build it instead of pitching it.

03

Something silly

A product for one person. Your dog. Your team's running joke. Often the best ones.

Write the brief

Max five people. One document. One writer. No AI.
It is the only thing you reuse all session.

One thing before you start

HOW THIS WILL FEEL

Some of you will find this frustrating. Some will just start typing. Both are normal.

There are no rules in here, and there is no right answer. The only wrong move is waiting until you feel ready.

WHEN YOU GET STUCK

Ask the thing in front of you. It is very good at unsticking people.

“I am stuck. Ask me one question that will get me moving again.”

8:00

Write your brief

One doc. One writer. No AI yet.

- Choose your idea. One, not three.
- Who is it for
- What must it do
- What words do we use
- What must it never do
- How do we know it worked

2:00

Tool check

Pick one. The choice matters less than you think.

- A chatbot that builds: Claude · ChatGPT · Gemini · Copilot
- A UI generator: Google Stitch · Figma Make
- Any of them + “give me one self-contained HTML file”
- Or ask your AI which tool fits what you're building
- Already pay for Lovable, v0 or Bolt? Use it, but watch the credits.

Loop one

Prompt → Make → Inspect → Change. And then repeat.

Forbid the deliverable

DON'T

“Build me an app for scheduling team lunches.”

You get an app in ten seconds. It is generic, it is not yours, and now you are arguing with something that already exists.

DO

“Build nothing yet. Ask me the five questions you'd ask before building. One at a time.”

You get a conversation. And somewhere in question three it tells you what your brief was missing.

THE PROMPT

Build nothing yet.

You are an experienced product designer.
Here is what we want to make: [our brief]

1. Ask me the five questions you'd ask before building. One at a time.
2. Then tell me what you'd get wrong if you started now.
3. Only when I say go: build the smallest version we can look at. Make it look like a real product, not a demo. Pick a typeface and a palette and commit to them.

NOTICE

“Build nothing yet” breaks the default. Without it you get an app.

“One at a time” forces a conversation, not a delivery.

Step 2 is where it tells you your brief was thin.

The styling line is not vanity. Without it you get grey boxes, and grey boxes do not feel like something you made.

7:00

Prompt

Forbid the deliverable. Make it ask you things.

— “Build nothing yet.”

— Ask me five questions, one at a time

— Then: what would you get wrong?

— Only when I say go: build

PROMPT → MAKE → INSPECT → CHANGE

LOOP 1

14:00 Make

Your first result will be bad. That is the plan.

- Say go. Let it build.
- The smallest version you can look at
- A real product, not a demo. Pick a typeface and a palette.
- It will be bad. Keep it anyway.

PROMPT → MAKE → INSPECT → CHANGE

LOOP 1

3:00

Inspect

Three things that are wrong. Write them down. Fix nothing yet.

- Fix nothing yet
- Three things that are wrong
- Write them in your doc, under the brief

PROMPT → MAKE → INSPECT → CHANGE

LOOP 1

5:00

Change ONE thing

Then build again. One change, so you can see what moved.

- Pick ONE of your three
- Change it. Build again.
- One change, so you can see what moved

PROMPT → MAKE → INSPECT → CHANGE

LOOP 1

Hands up if your first result was worse than you expected.

Then two groups show a screen. Not more.

Swap

Read a brief you did not write. It will tell you something about your own.

Give your brief to the group behind you.

Send it to them, or let them photograph your screen. Back row: yours goes to the front.

4:00

Read theirs

Don't build it. Read it, and list what you would have to guess.

- Read the brief you received
- Write the three things you'd have to guess
- Do not ask them what they meant

What was unclear in the brief you received?

Tell the group who wrote it. They cannot fix what they never hear.

Loop two

Back to your own product. It never left your screen.

THE ROLE SWITCH

Stop being the designer.

You are now: [a specific person in a specific situation who would use this].

Forget what we were trying to do.
React to what is actually there.

Answer in the first person:
a reaction, not an analysis.

1. What's the first thing you think?
2. What do you think is NOT here?
3. What would you tell a colleague?
4. One to ten: do you trust this?
And why not ten?

NOTICE

Same chat. It already has your product. Nothing to paste, nothing to link.

“Forget what we were trying to do” is doing the heavy lifting here.

“In the first person” is the whole difference.

Question 2 is the one that hurts, and the one worth using.

6:00

Inspect

Same chat. New role. It already has everything it needs.

- Stay in the chat you built in
- “Stop being the designer. You are now...”
- “Forget what we were trying to do.”
- Question two: what do you think is NOT here?

4:00

Decide one change

Write it in the doc before you type it into the tool.

DECIDE

LOOP 2 · 01:13

forte

advice

12:00

Build version two

The one you'll still have tomorrow.

CHANGE

LOOP 2 · 01:17

forte

advice

What moved between version one and two?

Two or three groups. The difference, not the demo.

That's the loop. You just ran it twice.

Two versions of something that did not exist an hour ago. Nobody wrote a specification.

The price

The part no vendor puts on a slide.

It demos perfectly. None of it works.

THE NEW FAILURE MODE

A prototype that looks finished is not the same as one that is.

AI is exceptional at the looking-finished part. That's the same strength from slide eight, pointed at you.

WHY IT'S EXPENSIVE

Because a room full of people made a decision based on it.

The old bad prototype announced itself. This one doesn't.

What would your prototype fail at in real life?

In your group. Thirty seconds.

The conversation moved

BEFORE

We described concepts. We argued about what each of us had pictured.

The best describer won the meeting. Nobody knew whether it would work.

NOW

You build it first, badly, in fourteen minutes. Then the conversation starts.

It is about something real, and everyone is looking at the same thing.

The thinking happens between version one and two.

That is the part that used to be too expensive to do. It isn't any more, and judging what came back is your job now.

Five moves

01

Brief

Half a page. Written once, reused everywhere.

02

Prompt

Forbid the deliverable.
Make it ask.

03

Make

Expect the first one to be bad.

04

Inspect

Yourself, then through someone else's eyes.

05

Change

One thing. Then go again.

Take it with you

The five moves, the prompts, and one thing to try on Monday.



THE SHEET

jarllyng.github.io/prompt-make-repeat



MADE BY HUMAN

madebyhuman.iamjarl.com

And one favour

Rate the session in the conference app. It takes ten seconds, and it is the only feedback I get.

THANK YOU

Prompt.
Make.
Repeat.

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No AI was harmed during this workshop. I hope.